MODULE 7 WORKSHEET

From Resistance to Resolution Objection Planner

A tactic loses most of its power the moment you recognise it. Use this planner to predict the tactics you may face, prepare your counters and check your own tactics for integrity. It takes 20–30 minutes.

Negotiation I'm preparing for: _____ **Date:** _____

01 Tactic forecast

Which tactics are they most likely to use? Write the warning sign you will watch for and the exact sentence you will use.

TACTIC I EXPECT	WARNING SIGN	MY COUNTER, WORD FOR WORD

Decode with five questions: What is the tactic? · Why does it work? · What are the warning signs? · How do I counter it? · Is there an honest way to use it?

02 My anchors against pressure

QUESTION	MY ANSWER
My BATNA, in one sentence	
Market data that backs my numbers	
My real deadline (if any), and its reason	

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03 Warning-sign checklist

Keep this page next to you. Tick each sign you notice during the negotiation.

PRESSURE
☐ **Ultimatum or threat:** "final offer", "we'll cancel"
☐ **False deadline:** no reason, or it shifts
☐ **Outburst:** yelling, "This is outrageous!"
☐ **Silence:** a long pause, a blank stare
☐ **Flinch:** a gasp, "That's way too high!"
NUMBERS AND TRADES
☐ **Highball / lowball:** far outside the norms
☐ **Bracketing:** new ranges, midpoint logic
☐ **Bogey:** a minor issue overemphasised
☐ **Nibbling:** "Just one more thing…"
☐ **Cherry picking:** the discount without the commitment

DISTRACTION AND CONFUSION
☐ **Red herring:** topic changes when progress is made
☐ **Strawman:** "So you're saying…" plus exaggeration
☐ **Playing dumb:** the same basic questions again
☐ **Overwhelm:** giant packets, jargon
☐ **Delay:** "still waiting on sign-off"
AUTHORITY, TEAMS AND CLOSING
☐ **Good cop / bad cop:** one harsh, one warm
☐ **Limited authority:** "I need to check with my manager."
☐ **Higher authority:** "Legal won't approve that."
☐ **Divide and conquer:** "You seem more reasonable…"
☐ **Last-minute change:** "Before we sign, just add…"

When you spot one: stay calm · name it or ask about it · return to the facts, the real decision-makers and the timeline.

04 Tactic log

Note what happens as it happens. A quick note during a break is enough.

WHAT THEY SAID OR DID	TACTIC	HOW I RESPONDED

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05 My lines for hard moments

Write each line in your own words, so it sounds natural when you need it.

MOMENT	MY LINE
They say "final offer" Test it, then a calibrated question	
They flinch at my number Pause, then walk through the rationale	
They ask for "one more thing" Tie it to something in return	
They need "to check with someone" Who decides, what concern, by when	
Emotions run high Acknowledge, then offer a pause	

06 Team roles

ROLE	WHO
Leads on commercial terms	
Leads on scope and delivery	
Watches for tactics and takes notes	
Our time-out signal	

07 Integrity check for my own tactics

- [ ] Every deadline and consequence I mention is real, and I'm prepared to follow through.
- [ ] Any issue I emphasise is something I genuinely value. I haven't invented a dealbreaker.
- [ ] My ambitious numbers are justifiable, and I can explain them.
- [ ] Any emotion I show is genuine. I'm not exploiting someone vulnerable.
- [ ] I would be comfortable if they knew exactly how I prepared.

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08 After-action review

Fill this in within 24 hours of the negotiation.

QUESTION	WHAT HAPPENED
Which tactics did they use? Did I spot them in time?	
Which counter worked best? Which didn't?	
When did I feel pressure to concede? What triggered it?	
Did anything change at the last minute? How did I handle it?	
Did I use any tactic myself? Was it honest?	
What will I prepare differently next time?	

Agreed next steps (what, who, by when):

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